Tayten Bennetsen

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EDUCATION

Rice University **Houston, Texas**
B.S. in Computer Science and B.A. in Cognitive Science Expected Graduation, April 2027

- **GPA:** 3.75/4.00
- **Concentrations:** DSA, Software Engineering, Machine Learning, OOP, Operating Systems, AI, Project Management

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer Intern Co-op | Voodoo — June 2025 – Present
Nomad - iOS social travel app — Swift | Python | AWS | Git | Google Maps API | Apify Scraper

- Collaborating with Voodoo developers on an iOS **travel-social** application that overlays social network driven recommendations for **50+ cities**.
- Built **SVD-based recommendation engine** to solve content discovery challenges, enabling personalized user-generated content feeds.
- Developed **8 core AWS Lambda** functions for back-end authentication, Maps/TikTok scraping, and CRUD, reducing server costs by **60%**.

AI Software Engineer Intern | Wostmann & Associates — May 2025 – Present
AI-driven RFP/Procurement scraper — Python | Django | Docker | Scikit Learn | TensorFlow | Agentic AI

- Architecting a **Dockerized Python/Django** pipeline to scrape, classify, and rank RFPs/bids, boosting lead discovery efficiency by **50%**.
- Integrated **ML ranking logic** (scikit-learn + custom NLP heuristics) with **99.5%** relevance accuracy to surface high-priority opportunities.
- Deployed automated data ingestion via **containerized agentic pipelines**, scraping **28** different government, state, and private sector RFP sources into a **Postgres** database.

Founding Software Engineer | Signacer — Nov 2024 – Present
Athlete–fan connection app — Swift | SwiftUI | Firebase | Git

- Leading **Swift** development for a real-time athlete–fan engagement platform, implementing QR authentication, chat, and notification services.
- Architected **Firebase** back-end (Auth, Firestore, Cloud Functions) to support scalable data storage, real-time messaging, and push notifications.
- Coordinated feature planning and sprint execution in an **Agile** workflow alongside co-founders; already have **3** signed athletes and are projected to onboard **250+** users in the next quarter.

Software Engineer Intern | Wostmann & Associates — May 2024 - Aug 2024
Created open source screen reader for visually impaired users — C++ | WinAPI | Microsoft UI Automation | Windows Speech API

- Designed **SightSpeak Reader** using C++, integrating WinAPI, Microsoft UI Automation, and Windows Speech API to enable real-time text-to-speech output and visual text highlighting, supporting over **4,000** Microsoft applications.
- Developed recursive BFS tree traversal for seamless navigation through UI elements, improving navigation speed by **80%** for beta users.
- Leveraged a **thread pool** and futures/promises for concurrent tasks, reducing text processing latency by **120ms** for smooth user interface.

PROJECTS

Full-Stack Project | Bunkmate — Sep 2024 – Present
Rice University centralized student housing and subletting platform — Next.js | TypeScript | Supabase | Tailwind CSS | Google Maps API

- Developed a **Next.js/TypeScript** application enabling Rice students to post, search, and manage sublets/off-campus housing.
- Implemented **Supabase Auth** with role-based access control to secure user data and restrict listings management.
- Architected real-time database interactions in **Supabase** for favorites, user profiles, and listing updates, resulting in **600+** monthly-active users and **250+** listings within two months.
- Developed as part of **Rice Apps** student developer community, leading weekly agile sprints and mentoring new members

Embedded Software Project | Rice OwlSat — Oct 2024 – May 2025
NASA-sponsored embedded satellite software — CircuitPython | Raspberry Pi | I2C Sensors | PyCubed

- Developed **embedded software** in CircuitPython for Raspberry Pi 2350, reading sensor telemetry (IMU, GPS, temperature) over I2C and encoding data for ground-station transmission.
- Integrated sensor drivers and implemented fault-tolerant dual threaded data buffering, ensuring reliable operation under variable power conditions.
- Collaborated with hardware and mechanical teams to finalize flight software architecture for a **NASA-sponsored** CubeSat project.

AI Full-Stack Project | Pillora – AI Powered Medication Management — Sep 2024 – Oct 2024
Developed during HackRice 2024 — JavaScript | React | Node.js | MongoDB | Tailwind CSS | OpenAI | OpenFDA | Express

- Led a team of 4 to build a cross-platform **React**/Node.js app focused on improving medication adherence for patients.
- Implemented **Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)** by integrating **OpenFDA API** with **OpenAI**, enhancing chatbot accuracy by 35% and reducing hallucinations by 90%.
- Architected a scalable backend using **MongoDB** and **Express**, supporting up to 250 concurrent users with minimal latency.
- Awarded **2nd Place Overall** and **1st in Healthcare** at HackRice 2024.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages | C, C++, JavaScript, Java, Python, React, React Native, CSS, HTML, CircuitPython, SQL, R, TypeScript
Programming Tools | AWS, MongoDB, Supabase, Firebase, Postgres, Git, OpenAI, Anthropic, Linux, Postman, VS Code, Docker
Frameworks/Libraries | Next.js, Node.js, Express.js, Django, JUnit, PyTorch, Scikit-Learn, TensorFlow, LangChain, Pandas